

GLOSSARY

Adaptation A feature of an animal or plant that helps it to survive and reproduce in its environment.

Algae (*Singular* alga) Simple, nonflowering plants. Seaweeds are algae.

Amino acid A chemical that is used to make proteins in cells.

Amphibian A cold-blooded animal that can live on land and in water.

Arthropod

An invertebrate animal that has a hard exoskeleton, a segmented body, and jointed limbs.

Biodiversity The number and variety of species living in a particular place.

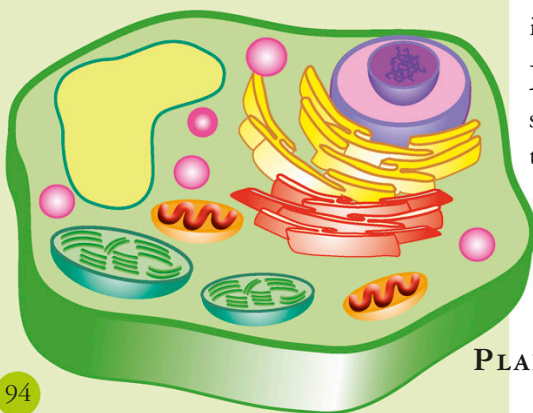
Broadleaf A type of tree that has wide leaves that drop off in winter.

Cell The smallest independent part of a living thing.

Cellulose A chemical found in the walls of plant cells.

Chlorophyll The green pigment that gives plants their color.

Chloroplast A tiny organelle found in plant cells where photosynthesis occurs.



PLANT CELL

Climate The weather conditions that are usual for an area over a long period of time.

Cnidarians A group of soft-bodied animals that live in water. They include jellyfish and anemones.

Colony A group of animals living closely together or joined together in a structure.

Commensalism

A relationship between two organisms where one benefits and the other is neither helped nor harmed.

Crustacean A hard-shelled animal with a pair of limbs on each body segment and two pairs of antennae.

Decomposer An organism that helps to break down dead material into essential nutrients that can be returned to the soil.

DNA (deoxyribonucleic acid) The chemical code that details everything about an organism and how it functions.

Dormancy When organisms slow or suspend their normal functions until conditions improve.

Ecosystem The plants, fungi, animals, and bacteria that live together in a particular environment.

Element A pure chemical substance that consists of a single type of atom.

Enzyme A type of protein found in a cell that is used to break or join molecules.



Evolution The process by which living things change over millions of years to become more suited to their environment.

Extinction When the last remaining organism in a species dies out leaving no offspring.

Exoskeleton A hard, external skeleton that protects an invertebrate animal's body.

Extremophile An organism that can survive under extreme physical conditions.

Fertilization The fusing together of male and female cells to produce a new organism.

Genes Sections of DNA that specify the body features and the characteristics of an organism.

Glycolysis The process used by cells to break down sugars into smaller molecules.

Habitat The place or environment where an animal lives naturally.

Hermaphrodite An animal that carries both male and female sex cells so that it can produce offspring when no mate is available.

Hibernation The ability of some animals to slow their bodily activities for a period so that they appear to be in a deep sleep. This usually happens when food is scarce.

